

01_calder_mourne

CLASS: UNKNOWN | RACE: HUMAN | LEVEL: ?

ABILITY SCORES

ABILITY	SCORE	NOTES
Strength	17	+1 to hit, +1 damage
Dexterity	13	-1 AC
Constitution	16	+2 hp/die
Intelligence	11	,
Wisdom	12	,
Charisma	14	Reaction +1

SAVING THROWS

Death / Poison	9
Wands	10
Paralyzation	11
Breath Weapon	11
Spells	12

COMBAT STATISTICS

HP: 58
AC: 0
THACO: 14
ATTACKS/RD: 3/2
MOVEMENT: 6"

WEAPONS & ATTACKS

WEAPON	+HIT	DAMAGE	NOTES
Longsword +2	+3	1d8+3	+2 magic, +1 Str to hit, +1 Str d...
Hand axe (×2)	+1	1d6+1	Thrown range 1"/2"/3"
Dagger	+1	1d4+1	Last resort

EQUIPMENT

Worn: Plate mail, medium shield, longsword +2 at hip, hand axe ×2 on belt, dagger in boot, backpack
Pack: 50 ft hempen rope, grappling hook, rations ×5, lantern, flask of oil ×3, bedroll, flint & steel, 10 iron spikes, small hammer
Coin: 62 gp, 15 sp

MAGIC ITEMS

LONGSWORD +2:
A straight-bladed sword from a Shield Lands armoury, etched with the unit number of a cavalry regiment that no longer exists. No special powers beyond enchantment.

POTION OF EXTRA HEALING:
A dark amber liquid in a ceramic vial sealed with red wax. Restores 3d8+3 hit points. Calder has been carrying this for two months and hasn't needed it yet, which he considers either lucky or ominous.

RING OF PROTECTION +1:
A plain iron band on his right hand. Contributes to his AC. He does not know where it came from, it was in an evidence box from a previous commission, unclaimed.

PERSONALITY

- Economical with words. States objectives, checks progress, moves on. Not cold, just efficient.

- Has a professional respect for competence in others regardless of class or background. Will follow a good plan from anyone.

- Does not use the dust. Has watched enough soldiers get creative with questionable substances and knows how that ends.

Calder Mourné

HUMAN FIGHTER

You spent twelve years riding with the Shield Lands heavy cavalry. You were good at it. Then the regiment was dissolved in a political restructuring you have no interest in explaining to anyone, and you found yourself moderately experienced, moderately paid, and without a unit. That was four years ago.

Since then you have been taking independent security contracts. Escort work, clearance operations, the occasional thing that does not have an official name. You have built a reputation for following through, which is the only reputation in this line of work that actually pays.

You know Ranger-Captain Elnara from a previous job. You do not discuss the details of that job. What you know about her is: she is precise, she does not waste words, and she is not in the habit of exaggerating threats. When her letter arrived two weeks ago – “Something in the Thicket needs ending. Your kind of work. Standard rates.” – you accepted without asking for details. You have learned that asking for details from Elnara is unproductive.

The cargo contract was simple enough. A gnome named Blink Tinderflip needed two coaches driven from Critwall to Ringstown, sensitive cargo, deliver intact to Elnara. You took the coachman role on one of them. You didn’t ask what was inside. You never do.

02_kaida_swift

CLASS: UNKNOWN | RACE: HUMAN | LEVEL: ?

ABILITY SCORES

ABILITY	SCORE	NOTES
Strength	11	
Dexterity	18	+2 missile to hit, +4 AC
Constitution	13	
Intelligence	14	
Wisdom	10	
Charisma	13	Reaction +1

SAVING THROWS

Death / Poison	10
Wands	14
Paralyzation	11
Breath Weapon	15
Spells	13

COMBAT STATISTICS

HP: 28
AC: 2
THACO: 17
ATTACKS/RD: 1
MOVEMENT: 12"

WEAPONS & ATTACKS

WEAPON	+HIT	DAMAGE	NOTES
Shortsword +1	+1	1d6+1	Primary melee
Dagger (x3)	+2	1d4	+2 Dex missile (thrown only); ...
Hand crossbow	+2	1d3	12 bolts; range 2"/4"/6"; +2 D...

THIEF SKILLS

Pick Pockets	60%	Hide in Shadows	60%
Open Locks	65%	Hear Noise	30%
Find / Remove Traps	55%	Climb Walls	75%
Move Silently	75%	Read Languages	30%

EQUIPMENT

Worn: Leather armour, small shield, shortsword +1 at hip, 3 daggers on belt, hand crossbow on back strap, ring on left hand

Pack: Thieves' tools (complete), 50 ft silk rope, grappling hook, rations x4, 2 flasks alchemist's fire, mirror (small steel), chalk, 12 crossbow bolts, dark travelling cloak

Coin: 48 gp, 22 sp

MAGIC ITEMS

SHORTSWORD +1:

A narrow blade with a wrapped leather grip worn smooth from use. The balance is exceptional, it almost finds the target on its own, though that is probably just a metaphor.

RING OF PROTECTION +1:

Carved from dark bone, set in a thin silver band. Her Critwall client gave it to her before the job. She doesn't know where he got it and has stopped thinking about that.

DUST ANTITOXIN (1 DOSE):

She acquired this in Critwall before departing, from a contact who knew more about the dust trade than he was comfortable admitting. Bitter grey tincture in a wax-sealed vial. +2 to the next saving throw against dust backlash effects.

PERSONALITY

- Watches everyone's hands. Occupational habit. She is not suspicious of the party specifically; she is suspicious of everyone equally.
- Will share information when it is tactically useful to do so. Withholds it when it is not. Considers this honest behaviour.
- Has a genuine reaction to Orn's body in Area 6 if she has met him at Area 3, the post-mortem Kcarved into his forehead unsettles her in a way she does not hide well.

Raida Swift

HUMAN THIEF

Six years in the Critwall information markets has taught you that the people who ask the right questions early get paid; the people who ask the wrong questions late get hurt. You do courier work, evidence recovery, the occasional quiet extraction. You are good at not being seen, good at finding things people have hidden, and very good at knowing when a job has more layers than the client admitted to.

This job has layers.

03_sable_crane

CLASS: UNKNOWN | RACE: HUMAN | LEVEL: ?

ABILITY SCORES

ABILITY	SCORE	NOTES
Strength	15	+0 to hit, +0 damage
Dexterity	17	+2 missile to hit, +3 AC
Constitution	14	,
Intelligence	12	,
Wisdom	15	+1 magical defence bonus
Charisma	11	,

SAVING THROWS

Death / Poison	10
Wands	11
Paralyzation	12
Breath Weapon	12
Spells	13

COMBAT STATISTICS

HP: 50
AC: 3 (just below bonus three...)
THACO: 15
ATTACKS/RD: 3/2
MOVEMENT: 12"

WEAPONS & ATTACKS

WEAPON	+HIT	DAMAGE	NOTES
Longsword +1	+1	1d8+1	Primary melee
Shortsword	+0	1d6	Off-hand; rangers may two-w...
Longbow	+2	1d8	+2 Dex missile; range 7"/14"/2...

EQUIPMENT

Worn: Studded leather, longsword +1, shortsword, longbow, quiver with 24 arrows, dagger in boot

Pack: 50 ft hempen rope, rations x6, waterskin, bedroll, fire-starting kit, tracking kit (plaster for casting prints, charcoal, paper), healer's kit (2 uses of cure light wounds equivalent bandaging, restores 1d3 hp each use, once per wound), signal whistle

Coin: 38 gp, 10 sp

MAGIC ITEMS

LONGSWORD +1:

A plain military blade with a worn crossguard. Given to her by the garrison commander when she left service. She has never named it.

BOOTS OF ELVENKIND:

Soft grey-leather boots that make no sound on any natural surface, stone, wood, mud, leaf litter. Sable has had these for two years and they are the reason she is still alive. Her Move Silently in these boots is effectively 75% outdoors.

POTION OF HEALING:

Standard preparation, 1d8+1 hp. Cork-stoppered glass vial in an oilskin wrap.

PERSONALITY

- Talks to herself in the forest. Has been doing it for years. Does not realise she does it.
- Very patient. Will wait longer than any other party member before concluding that something is gone, dead, or not coming back. This is both a virtue and an occasional problem.
- Takes the owlbear personally. Not because it attacked her, it didn't, but because she watched it cross the southern meadow six weeks ago moving normally, and she knows what it was before it became this.

Sable Crane

HUMAN RANGER

You worked game warden patrol in the roadwoods south of the Thicket for four years before the garrison was cut and you were let go with back pay and a handshake. You have been working the same routes freelance ever since – leading trapper parties, scouting for merchant groups, the occasional boundary survey. You know the Thicket’s southern approaches better than anyone currently alive in Ringstown who is not missing.

You knew something was wrong before anyone official acknowledged it. The birds told you. Or rather: the birds stopped telling you things, which is how the forest tells you that an area has gone bad.

04_tessaly_vorn

CLASS: UNKNOWN | RACE: HUMAN | LEVEL: ?

ABILITY SCORES

ABILITY	SCORE	NOTES
Strength	12	
Dexterity	10	
Constitution	13	
Intelligence	14	
Wisdom	17	+3 magical defence bonus: bonus spell*
Charisma	14	Reaction +1

SAVING THROWS

Death / Poison	9
Wands	13
Paralyzation	10
Breath Weapon	12
Spells	14

COMBAT STATISTICS

HP: 32
AC: 3
THACO: 18
ATTACKS/RD: 1
MOVEMENT: 9"

WEAPONS & ATTACKS

WEAPON	+HIT	DAMAGE	NOTES
Mace +1	+1	1d6+1	St. Cuthbert's symbol; she con...
Heavy mace (backup)	+0	1d6+1	Carried in pack
Sling	+0	1d4	20 lead bullets; range 5"/10"/20"

SPELLS MEMORISED

- Silence, 1y' Radius

2ND LEVEL (3 SLOTS)

- Hold Person
- Slow Poison

3RD LEVEL (2 SLOTS)

- Dispel Magic

- Cure Disease

EQUIPMENT

Worn: Chain mail, medium shield, mace +1, holy symbol (silver, cudgel design), ring on right hand

Pack: Heavy mace, sling + 20 bullets, rations ×4, waterskin, bedroll, writing kit (journal, inkpot, quill), 3 vials holy water, healer's kit (full; 4 uses of bandaging, 1d3 hp each), candles ×6, tinderbox, copy of the Teachings of St. Cuthbert (small octavo, worn)

Coin: 44 gp, 8 sp

MAGIC ITEMS

MACE +1:

A well-balanced weapon with a head of black iron and a haft wrapped in red cord. The cudgel is St. Cuthbert's traditional symbol; she considers carrying it a form of devotional expression. It strikes true.

RING OF PROTECTION +1:

Silver ring with an engraved eye, St. Cuthbert's other symbol, representing piercing truth. Part of her temple kit.

HOLY WATER (3 VIALS):

Standard blessed water. Each vial deals 2d4 damage to undead on a direct hit. In this adventure, each vial also qualifies as an anchor for the Area 4 cleansing rite, the most potent anchor available. She should not use all three on undead when they might be needed at the pool; the referee should note this tension.

PERSONALITY

- Takes notes on everything. Her journal now has twelve pages on dust symptom progression, four pages on the pool's theological parallels, and a sketch of the K₇ mark that she finds herself redrawing when she is thinking about something else.

- St. Cuthbert is a god of honesty and righteous retribution. Tessaly applies both: she is straightforwardly honest with the party about her objectives, and she will not leave an evil that can be ended, unended.

- She has administered last rites three times since arriving in Ringstown. She is tired in a way she does not mention.

Tessaly Vorn

HUMAN CLERIC (ST. CUTHBERT)

Your temple sent you north because three separate reports arrived in the same month describing the same thing: survivors who compulsively carved a specific letter – K – into whatever surface was nearest to them. Walls, floors, skin. They did not remember doing it. Some of them were still doing it when the reports were written.

The letter is not a holy symbol. It is not associated with any deity your temple recognises. And yet the compulsion it produces is eerily similar to certain ritual states that your order has documented across two centuries of theological study. The similarity is what alarmed the senior curates. The dissimilarity – the fact that no known god answers to that letter – is what alarmed them more.

Your temple's assessment was this: either something new is making plays through a physical substance and calling itself by an old wizard's initial, or something very old has found a new method. Either possibility required investigation on the ground. You were the available curate with relevant field experience. You packed the Teachings and left within the week.

05_mordechai_fletch

CLASS: UNKNOWN | RACE: HUMAN | LEVEL: ?

ABILITY SCORES

ABILITY	SCORE	NOTES
Strength	9	
Dexterity	14	51 AC
Constitution	12	
Intelligence	18	+10% to learn spells; reads all languages; ad...
Wisdom	13	
Charisma	11	

SAVING THROWS

Death / Poison	12
Wands	9
Paralyzation	11
Breath Weapon	13
Spells	10

COMBAT STATISTICS

HP: 18
AC: 6
THACO: 19
ATTACKS/RD: 1
MOVEMENT: 12"
spells; reads all languages; ad...

WEAPONS & ATTACKS

WEAPON	+HIT	DAMAGE	NOTES
Dagger +1	+1	1d4+1	Last resort only
Staff	+0	1d6	Walking stick. Also a staff.
Wand of Magic Missiles	,	1d4+1/missile	See below

SPELLS MEMORISED

- Detect Magic

1ST LEVEL (4 SLOTS)

- Magic Missile
- Charm Person

2ND LEVEL (2 SLOTS)

- Web

- Invisibility

3RD LEVEL (2 SLOTS)

- Fireball

- Slow

EQUIPMENT

Worn: Bracers of Defence, dagger +1 at belt, component pouch (on bandolier), spectacles (his own, not magical, just necessary), travelling robes

Pack: Spellbook (leather-covered, locked with a small key he wears around his neck), wand of magic missiles, scroll case (2 scrolls), journal, inkpot ×2, quills ×6, rations ×3, waterskin, candles ×4, tinderbox

Coin: 52 gp, 30 sp

MAGIC ITEMS

BRACERS OF DEFENCE (AC 7):

Engraved bone bracers that provide protection equivalent to AC 7 armour. He wears no other armour, magic-users cannot cast spells in metal armour, and he refuses to be caught without spells.

WAND OF MAGIC MISSILES (9 CHARGES):

An ash-wood wand tipped with a polished iron cap. Each activation fires one magic missile (1d4+1 damage, never misses). Can fire multiple charges at once (up to 3 missiles per round at 1 charge each). Currently has 9 charges. He is conservative with it.

DAGGER +1:

More useful as a letter opener than a weapon at this point.

SCROLL OF IDENTIFY:

A single-use scroll that allows the casting of Identify without preparation. Useful for the obsidian disc at Area 3, the fresh obsidian disc at Area 7, or any other unknown magical item the party recovers. Casting takes one turn, requires 100 gp of pearl dust as a material component (he has it).

SCROLL OF PROTECTION FROM MAGIC:

Single use. Creates a globe of total magic immunity for the caster for 1 turn. Does not protect adjacent characters.

PERSONALITY

- Narrates what he is observing while he observes it. The party finds this useful about 60% of the time and annoying the other 40%.
- Concerned, specifically and professionally, about anyone who uses the dust. Will explain exactly what it is doing to them, with more detail than they probably wanted.
- Will not use the dust himself under any circumstances. He knows precisely what happens to the mind under prolonged exposure and the answer is: exactly what Keraptis wants.

Mordechai Fletch

HUMAN MAGIC-USER

You have published two monographs. The first: On the Theory of Consciousness Transfer and Its Known Failure Modes. The second: Fragmented Presence: What Partial Transfers Leave Behind. You are working on a third. Your area of expertise is the wizardly ambition of copying a living mind into a new vessel — the theory, the mathematics, the history of attempts, and, most importantly, the ways it goes catastrophically wrong.

You know the theory is sound in principle. You know it is catastrophically dangerous in practice. You have spent twelve years studying the failure modes precisely so that you understand what not to do, and because the failure modes are, frankly, more interesting than the successes.

When reports of a substance that compels carving a specific wizard's initial reached the Critwall scholarly community, you were one of three people in the room who understood immediately what they were hearing. You were the only one who got up and started packing.

Someone is doing badly what you have spent twelve years studying how to do properly. This offends you professionally.

06_brynn_ashwood

CLASS: UNKNOWN | RACE: HUMAN | LEVEL: ?

ABILITY SCORES

ABILITY	SCORE	NOTES
Strength	10	,
Dexterity	13	51 AC
Constitution	15	+1 hp/die
Intelligence	13	,
Wisdom	16	+2 magical defence bonus
Charisma	14	Reaction +1; 1

SAVING THROWS

Death / Poison	9
Wands	13
Paralyzation	10
Breath Weapon	12
Spells	14

COMBAT STATISTICS

HP: 38
AC: 5
THACO: 18
ATTACKS/RD: 1
MOVEMENT: 12"

WEAPONS & ATTACKS

WEAPON	+HIT	DAMAGE	NOTES
Scimitar +1	+1	1d8+1	Primary melee; Druids use cur...
Sling	+0	1d4	Range 5"/10"/20"; 20 bullets
Dagger	+0	1d4	Utility /last resort

SPELLS MEMORISED

1ST LEVEL (3 SLOTS)

- Entangle
- Faerie Fire

2ND LEVEL (3 SLOTS)

- Barkskin
- Slow Poison

3RD LEVEL (2 SLOTS)

- Hold Animal

EQUIPMENT

Worn: Leather armour, medium shield, scimitar +1, wooden holy symbol (ash-leaf design), ring on left hand
Pack: Sling + 20 bullets, dagger, rations x5, waterskin of Ringstown well water (full, see below), bedroll, holly and mistletoe (Druidic focus), healer's herbs (4 uses, each restores 1d4 hp and neutralises mild poison), 50 ft hempen rope, small hand axe (utility tool)
Coin: 32 gp, 18 sp

MAGIC ITEMS

SCIMITAR +1:
A blade she inherited from her grove's previous warden, who did not survive a troll encounter three years ago. She carries it as a reminder that competence is not the same as invincibility.

RING OF PROTECTION +1:
A simple wooden ring, lacquered and hardened. Given to her by the grove council when she left to investigate the Thicket. "Come back," they said. She intends to.

POTION OF HEALING:
Standard preparation, 1d8+1 hp. Wrapped in oilskin in the bottom of her pack.

WATERSKIN OF RINGSTOWN WELL WATER:
Not magical, just well water from before she entered the Thicket. The Ringstown well is noted as drawing from a pre-Flan source that predates the current contamination. This waterskin qualifies as a valid anchor for Old Brindle's cleansing rite at Area 4. Brynn brought it specifically because she read the signs and suspected she might need something clean and untouched.

PERSONALITY

- Speaks to trees, animals, and plants as a matter of course. Does not apologise for this. Genuinely listens for responses.
- Has a pragmatist's relationship with death, living things die, that is the nature of living things, but what is happening in the Thicket is not natural death and she distinguishes between the two clearly.
- Will argue for calming the owlbear rather than killing it, clearly and without apology, until the evidence suggests it is impossible. Then she will say "I understand" and help kill it cleanly.

Brynn Ashwood

HUMAN DRUID

You have been grove-warden for five years, managing the woodland commons south of the Critwall road. Your grove touches the southern edge of the Twisted Thicket, which means you have been watching the contamination advance toward you one season at a time. This is not a metaphor. You have observed it the way you observe the progress of disease in a stand of trees: species by species, meadow by meadow, the silence spreading outward from somewhere in the north.

You came to Ringstown three weeks ago to report what you had seen: the deteriorating vegetation at the Thicket's edge, the white powder on a dead fox's muzzle, the absence of the songbirds. You brought samples. You had documentation.

Ranger-Captain Elnara looked at your samples and said: "I know. Wait here."

You have been waiting. You are not good at waiting when things are dying.

07_wulfrie_stone

CLASS: UNKNOWN | RACE: HUMAN | LEVEL: ?

ABILITY SCORES

ABILITY	SCORE	NOTES
Strength	18/45	+1 to hit, +3 damage
Dexterity	12	,
Constitution	17	+3 hp/die *(warrior)*, +3 to saves vs. magic...
Intelligence	10	,
Wisdom	11	,
Charisma	8	Reaction -1

SAVING THROWS

Death / Poison	10
Wands	11
Paralyzation	12
Breath Weapon	13
Spells	14

COMBAT STATISTICS

HP: 60
AC: 1
THACO: 16
ATTACKS/RD: 3/2
MOVEMENT: 6"

WEAPONS & ATTACKS

WEAPON	+HIT	DAMAGE	NOTES
Warhammer +1 (own)	+2	1d4+1+3 = 1d4...	+1 magic, +1 to hit / +3 damage...
Whelm *(if found, Area 2)*	+2*	1d4+1+3 = 1d4...	*See Whelm notes below*
Hand axe ×2	+1	1d6+4	Thrown range 1"/2"/3"
Dagger	+1	1d4+3	,

EQUIPMENT

Worn: Plate mail, medium shield, warhammer +1 at belt, hand axe ×2 on belt, dagger in boot, ring on right hand

Pack: 50 ft hempen rope, rations ×5, bedroll, lantern, flask of oil ×2, flint & steel, iron spikes ×10, small hammer (utility), whetstone, 2 sp worth of pipe tobacco and a short clay pipe

Coin: 42 gp, 25 sp

MAGIC ITEMS

WARHAMMER +1 (HIS OWN):

A solid weapon he has carried for eight years, reheaded twice. He trusts it. He is going to feel strange about setting it aside when Whelm enters the picture, but he is going to set it aside anyway, because he will feel the difference the moment he holds Whelm and he is not a complicated man about these things.

RING OF PROTECTION +1:

Iron band, worn on his right hand. Standard military-issue from his garrison days; he bought it off a retiring officer.

POTION OF GIANT STRENGTH:

A murky brown liquid that smells of iron and something organic. Consuming it temporarily grants Strength 21 (Exceptional Strength, +3 to hit, +9 damage) for 1 turn (10 rounds). He should use this when fighting the owlbear. He has been saving it for something worthy of it.

PERSONALITY

- Does not elaborate. States facts, asks one question, proceeds. Has been told this is brusque. Considers brusque to be neutral.
- Deeply loyal to people he has worked with before. Calder is in this category. He would not say this out loud.
- Will not use the dust, not from moral principle but because he has watched what happens to soldiers who supplement their courage chemically, and the sequel is never worth the opening act.

Wulfrie Stone

DWARF FIGHTER

Fifteen years garrison work in the Shield Lands. Eventually made sergeant-equivalent. Then a border reduction dissolved the unit and left you moderately well-paid and without a wall to watch. You have been doing security and escort work with Calder Mourne on and off for three years – he finds the jobs, you pack the plate mail, nobody discusses it as a formal arrangement because it does not need to be formal.

When Calder said "Elnara has a job in the north, involving a large and dangerous animal," you said "Reasonable" and started packing. You did not ask for additional details, because in your experience additional details rarely change what you end up doing with your hammer.

08_aldwyn_corr

CLASS: UNKNOWN | RACE: HUMAN | LEVEL: ?

ABILITY SCORES

ABILITY	SCORE	NOTES
Strength	17	+1 to hit, +1 damage
Dexterity	13	No AC adjustment
Constitution	15	+1 hp/die
Intelligence	11	,
Wisdom	14	+1 magical defence bonus
Charisma	17	Reaction +2

SAVING THROWS

Death / Poison	8
Wands	9
Paralyzation	10
Breath Weapon	10
Spells	11

COMBAT STATISTICS

HP: 50
AC: 1
THACO: 15
ATTACKS/RD: 3/2
MOVEMENT: 6"

WEAPONS & ATTACKS

WEAPON	+HIT	DAMAGE	NOTES
Longsword +1, Holy	+2	1d8+2	+1 magic, +1 Str to hit; +1 magi...
Dagger	+1	1d4+1	,
Light crossbow	+1	1d4+1	Range 6"/12"/18"; 20 bolts

EQUIPMENT

Worn: Plate mail +1, heavy shield, longsword +1 (Holy) at hip, dagger on belt, holy symbol of Heironeous (silver lightning bolt on a starburst, worn at the throat)
Pack: Light crossbow, 20 bolts, rations ×5, waterskin, bedroll, 50 ft hempen rope, healer's kit (4 uses, 1d3 hp each), candles ×6, tinderbox, writ of passage from the Order (official seal; useful for legal authority in Shield Lands territory, Ringtown falls within this jurisdiction)
Coin: 35 gp, 10 sp (Paladins are required to donate wealth above personal need to lawful good causes; Aldwyn is not rich)

MAGIC ITEMS

PLATE MAIL +1:

Ceremonial armour of the Order, not ornate, but well-maintained and faintly engraved with Heironeous's lightning bolt at the shoulder. Provides AC 1 combined with his shield. The enchantment is old; the armour was worn by a previous knight of the Order who died on a mission Aldwyn's commander described as "instructive."

LONGSWORD +1, HOLY:

The sword was blessed by a senior priest of Heironeous before Aldwyn's departure. Against undead and chaotic evil creatures, it deals an additional 1d6 damage per hit. Against all other targets it functions as a standard +1 weapon. The blade does not glow or make noise. Holiness, in Aldwyn's understanding, is not theatrical.

POTION OF HEROISM:

A deep crimson liquid that temporarily improves the imbiber's combat abilities for 2d6+10 rounds. Grants the equivalent of 2 additional fighter levels, improving THAC0 by 2 and adding 2d10 temporary hit points. Aldwyn received this from his Order's armoury. He has not used it. He is waiting for something that requires it.

PERSONALITY

- Formal without being cold. Addresses people by name when he knows it and by role when he doesn't. Has been told this seems distant. Considers clarity to be a form of respect.
- Takes the dust's compulsion effects more seriously than almost anyone else in the party, not because he is afraid, but because he has theological training in the difference between genuine divine compulsion and its counterfeits, and he finds the counterfeit quality of the dust deeply offensive.
- Will not execute a subdued enemy without due cause. Will stand between the party and someone they are about to kill in anger. Has done this before. Has the scars to prove it worked out eventually.

Aldwyn Corr

HUMAN PALADIN

You have been with the Order of the Radiant Shield for eleven years. Squire at fourteen, border garrison for four years, three years as a travelling knight-errant following up on isolated threats across the Shield Lands interior, then two years assigned to the Order's investigative function. Not espionage — the quiet work of following up on reports from remote parishes about things that look like divine interference but aren't.

Your superior's instructions before this posting were direct: "Find out if Keraptis is involved. If he is, find out how. If he isn't, find out what is using his name and why."